Euphoria — Product Vision Document v1

Author: Clara, Chief Product Officer

Date: March 25, 2026

Status: Draft — Founders Review Required

A Note on the Name

"Euphoria" is a **working title** and will be finalized later. We chose it as a placeholder because *euphoria* — an intense feeling of excitement, thrill, and elation — captures the core emotional promise of the product: the rush of surviving a round, the high of outlasting thousands of competitors, the dopamine hit of a perfect play. Whatever we name it, that feeling is what we're selling.

The One-Liner

Euphoria is a live, interactive game show platform where millions play together in real-time — and when shows aren't live, an endless stream of playable clips keeps them coming back.

The Vision

Euphoria becomes the default answer to "I have 10 minutes and want to feel something." It sits at the intersection of live television, mobile gaming, and social media — a category that doesn't cleanly exist yet.

At scale, Euphoria is:

- **A live entertainment network** running localized shows every hour, in every language, hosted by AI
- **An infinite content engine** where every show produces hundreds of replayable, shareable clips
- **A platform** where creators build and run their own game shows for global audiences

- **A daily habit** as reflexive as opening TikTok — except here, you're playing, not watching

The $1B revenue target in 5 years requires Euphoria to become a **top 10 mobile entertainment app globally**, with 15-20M+ DAU and a monetization model that blends the best of casual gaming (Royal Match) with ad-supported media (YouTube/TikTok). That's the bar.

Who It's For

Primary Persona: "The Thrill Seeker"

- **Age:** 18-35
- **Behavior:** Plays mobile games during commutes, lunch breaks, before bed. Watches game shows casually. Active on TikTok/Instagram Reels.
- **Motivation:** Wants to feel smart, fast, and competitive in short bursts. Craves the adrenaline of "can I survive this round?" Loves telling friends "I made it to Round 9 out of a million people."
- **Why Euphoria:** No other app gives them the feeling of competing live against hundreds of thousands of people in a game show they can join in 30 seconds.

Secondary Persona: "The Casual Clipper"

- **Age:** 16-45
- **Behavior:** Scrolls content feeds for entertainment. Plays casual mobile games (Candy Crush, Wordle). Doesn't commit to scheduled events easily.
- **Motivation:** Wants bite-sized, low-commitment entertainment. Will play a 15-second clip between activities. Occasionally joins live shows when notified.
- **Why Euphoria:** PlayClips give them an endless feed of snackable games — TikTok's scroll pattern with active participation instead of passive watching.

Tertiary Persona: "The Show Creator" (v2+)

- **Age:** 20-40
- **Behavior:** Content creator, aspiring host, educator, brand marketer
- **Motivation:** Wants to build an audience through interactive formats. Traditional video is saturated — game shows are a new content type.
- **Why Euphoria:** The platform gives them tools to create, host, and monetize their own game shows with zero production cost.

Product Architecture: The Two-Engine Model

Euphoria runs on two complementary experiences that feed each other:

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                      EUPHORIA                            │
│                                                          │
│   ┌────────────────┐        ┌──────────────────────┐    │
│   │  LIVE SHOWS    │        │   PLAYCLIPS          │    │
│   │                │        │                      │    │
│   │  Appointment   │──────► │  Always-on feed      │    │
│   │  event         │ shows  │  of playable         │    │
│   │  millions      │ feed   │  micro-games         │    │
│   │  play at once  │ clips  │  from past shows     │    │
│   │                │        │                      │    │
│   │  HIGH STAKES   │◄────── │  LOW STAKES          │    │
│   │  Elimination   │ users  │  No elimination      │    │
│   │  Currency      │ get    │  Async matchmaking   │    │
│   │  prizes        │ hyped  │  Skill building      │    │
│   └────────────────┘        └──────────────────────┘    │
│          │                          ▲                   │
│          │  Eliminated users        │                   │
│          │  SPECTATE rest of        │                   │
│          │  show → then PlayClips   │                   │
│          └──────────────────────────┘                   │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

Why this works:

- Live Shows create the *urgency* and *social proof* ("2M people playing right now!") that no on-demand experience can replicate
- PlayClips create the *daily habit* and fill the 23 hours between shows
- Eliminated players **spectate the rest of the show** — watching others play (and seeing rounds they *could* have survived) builds regret-driven purchase intent for next time. After the show ends, they transition into PlayClips while waiting for the next show.
- PlayClips exposure to game types builds familiarity and skill, making users more confident to join Live Shows
- Every Live Show automatically generates hundreds of new PlayClips — content scales with shows

Live Shows — The Main Event

Format

- **Duration:** ~10-15 minutes per show (gameplay + host segments + transitions)
- **Structure:** 10-12 micro-games played in sequence
- **Game duration:** 10-20 seconds per game
- **Host:** AI-generated (HeyGen + ElevenLabs), with potential for human/creator hosts in v2+
- **Participation:** Open to all — join with one tap when the show starts

The Elimination Flow

This is the heartbeat of the product. Every game is a survival check.

```
Show Start: 1,000,000 players
│
├─ Game 1 (Trivia): Answer wrong → eliminated
│  Survivors: ~650,000
│  ⚡ Monetization moment: "Retry? 10 coins"
│
├─ Game 2 (Reflex): Slowest 30% → eliminated
│  Survivors: ~450,000
│  ⚡ Monetization moment: "Retry? 15 coins"
│
├─ Game 3 (Spot the Difference): Miss it → eliminated
│  Survivors: ~300,000
│  ⚡ Monetization moment: "Retry? 20 coins"
│
├─ ... (difficulty and retry cost escalate) ...
│
├─ Game 10 (Final Round): Hardest challenge
│  Survivors: ~5,000-50,000
│
└─ Prize Distribution: Virtual currency split among survivors
   Show ends. Highlight reel plays. Next show countdown.
```

Key design principles:

- **Escalating stakes:** Retry cost increases each round — the deeper you go, the more you've invested, the harder it is to walk away
- **Escalating difficulty:** Games get harder as the show progresses, so survival feels earned

- **Speed kills:** The 10-20 second window means you can't overthink — instinct matters
- **Elimination is immediate and visceral:** Screen effect, sound, clear "YOU'RE OUT" moment — then straight into spectator mode

Post-Elimination Experience

When a player is eliminated: 1. Brief elimination animation (dramatic, not punishing) 2. Offer retry (primary monetization moment) 3. If they decline → **spectator mode by default.** Player watches the remaining rounds live. This is critical: seeing a trivia question you *knew* the answer to, or a reflex game you *would* have crushed, is the most powerful driver of future retry purchases. The spectator experience is a free ad for monetization. 4. Show ends → transition to PlayClips feed (keeps engagement alive until next show) 5. Push notification for next show ("Show starts in 55 minutes — will you survive longer?")

Show Cadence (Phased)

Phase	Shows/Day	Coverage
Launch (MVP)	2-3	Peak hours in primary market
Growth	6-8	Multiple timezones, themed shows
Maturity	24+ (hourly)	Global, localized, genre-specific

Localization Strategy

- AI dubbing (ElevenLabs) enables same show content in multiple languages
- Localized hosts (different AI personas per region) for cultural fit
- Region-specific show times aligned to local peak hours
- Potential for region-specific content (e.g., Bollywood trivia for India, K-pop trivia for Korea)

PlayClips — The Always-On Engine

What They Are

PlayClips are bite-sized, interactive clips extracted from past Live Shows. Each clip is a single micro-game — 10-20 seconds — presented in a vertical, scrollable feed.

The Experience

1. User opens app (outside of show time)
2. Full-screen PlayClip appears — a game ready to play
3. User plays (tap, swipe, type — depends on game type)
4. Result shows: score, time, and **live leaderboard against other players playing this clip right now**
5. Swipe up → next PlayClip (different game type, different show source)
6. Infinite scroll — recommendation engine serves the most relevant clips

Competitive Model: Async Real-Time Matchmaking

- No elimination in PlayClips — this preserves elimination as a Live Show exclusive
- Players are matched against others playing the same clip at the same moment
- Leaderboard shows real-time rankings ("You placed 12th out of 847 players on this clip")
- This creates competition without the anxiety of elimination — PlayClips are the *fun zone*, Live Shows are the *pressure zone*

Why No Elimination Stats from Live Shows in PlayClips

Deliberate choice: if PlayClips showed "only 23% survived this in the live show," it gives away the difficulty curve and reduces the surprise/tension of the Live Show. PlayClips should make you feel capable and excited to try the real thing — not intimidated.

PlayClips Monetization: Session Streak Protection

PlayClips have their own monetization lever, separate from Live Shows: **session win streaks.**

- As a user plays consecutive PlayClips correctly, their streak counter climbs
- Streak activates a **coin multiplier** on PlayClip earnings:
- Streak 0-4: 1x (base)
- Streak 5-9: 1.5x
- Streak 10-14: 2x
- Streak 15+: 3x
- Get a clip wrong → streak breaks and multiplier resets. **Unless** you spend coins to protect it.
- At higher streaks, protection is an economically rational decision (the multiplier earns you more than the protection costs), not just an emotional one

- Streak milestones (10, 20, 50) can trigger bonus rewards

Why session streaks, not daily streaks:

- Triggers *multiple* monetization moments per session, not one per day
- Mirrors the Live Show elimination psychology at lower stakes — "you're on a roll, protect it?" is a micro-version of "you survived 8 rounds, retry?"
- Adds tension to an otherwise no-stakes environment without replicating elimination
- Makes PlayClips a genuine coin-earning engine for skilled players, feeding the Live Show economy (more coins to spend on retries)

Daily retention is handled separately through a **standard daily rewards calendar** (login bonuses, escalating daily rewards) — a proven mobile game retention mechanic, distinct from the in-session streak.

Recommendation Engine

- **Phase 1:** Game-type preference (if user plays trivia clips longer, serve more trivia)
- **Phase 2:** Difficulty matching (serve clips at the user's skill level)
- **Phase 3:** Social signals (clips your friends played, trending clips)
- **Phase 4 (at scale):** Show-level recommendations (when show catalog is large enough)

Game Types

Confirmed for MVP Exploration

Game	Type	Live Show Fit	PlayClip Fit
Trivia / Quiz	Knowledge	✅	✅
Spot the Difference	Observation	✅	✅
Quick Math	Speed + Logic	✅	✅
Spelling Bee	Language	✅	✅
Fruit Cutting	Reflex	✅	✅
Knife at Center	Precision	✅	✅
Find Items	Observation	✅	✅

Explore During Playtesting

Game	Type	Notes
Word Puzzle	Language	May need pacing adjustment for live
Sudoku Puzzle	Logic	Likely PlayClip-only unless simplified
Brain Teaser	Logic	Format-dependent — some work fast, some don't
Rescue Someone	Puzzle	Needs definition — could be great if mechanic is simple

Game segmentation (live-only vs. PlayClip-only vs. both) will be finalized through playtesting once prototypes are built.

Monetization Framework

Primary: In-App Purchases (Elimination Economy)

The core monetization loop is **loss aversion during Live Shows:**

```
Player is eliminated
       │
       ▼
"Retry? Continue for 20 coins"
       │
       ├── Yes → Player continues, coins deducted
       │         (deeper investment → higher retry cost next time)
       │
       └── No → Player enters Spectator Mode (watches remaining rounds)
                Sees rounds they could have survived → builds purchase
                intent for next show. After show ends → PlayClips feed.
```

IAP Products:

Product	Purpose	Pricing Model
Coin packs	Universal currency for all spending	Tiered ($0.99 - $99.99)
Retries	Continue after elimination in Live Show	Escalating coin cost per round
Streak Protection	Preserve session win streak in PlayClips (and its coin multiplier)	Coin cost scales with streak length

Product	Purpose	Pricing Model
Extra Lives	Pre-purchased retries before a show starts	Bundled with coin packs
Powerups	In-game advantages (e.g., 50/50 on trivia, time extension)	Per-use coin cost

Economy Design (Royal Match-Inspired)

Single currency: Coins

- **Earn:** Survive Live Shows (prize pool distribution), PlayClip performance (boosted by streak multiplier), daily login rewards, achievements
- **Spend:** Retries, streak protection, powerups, cosmetics/items
- **Buy:** IAP with real money
- **Economy tension:** You earn coins by being good, but spend them when you're not good enough. This creates a natural sink that doesn't feel predatory — skilled players earn their way, others can buy their way, both feel fair.

Daily Rewards Calendar (Retention)

- Standard mobile game daily login bonus — escalating coin rewards for consecutive daily logins
- Separate from session streak protection — daily rewards drive *return visits*, session streaks drive *in-session engagement and spending*
- Resets after a full calendar cycle (e.g., 7 or 30 days), then starts again with higher tier

Secondary: Advertising

Ad Type	Placement	Revenue Model
OTT video ads	Between shows / during show intermissions	CPM
Playable game ads	In the PlayClips feed (marked as sponsored)	CPI/CPA from game developers
Show sponsorships	Branded shows, branded game rounds	Flat fee / CPM hybrid

Playable game ads in the PlayClips feed are a natural fit — the user is already in "play a quick game" mode, so a sponsored game clip feels native rather than intrusive.

Revenue Model (Illustrative)

Year	DAU (M)	IAP ARPDAU	Ad ARPDAU	Daily Rev	Annual Rev
1	0.5	$0.05	$0.02	$35K	~$13M
2	3	$0.10	$0.04	$420K	~$150M
3	8	$0.15	$0.06	$1.7M	~$610M
4	15	$0.18	$0.07	$3.75M	~$1.4B
5	20	$0.20	$0.08	$5.6M	~$2B

These are directional targets, not forecasts. Reality will be messy. The point: the math works if the product works.

Content Engine

Phase 1: In-House AI Shows

- Study the greatest game shows of all time (Jeopardy, Who Wants to Be a Millionaire, Deal or No Deal, Wipeout, The Chase, etc.)
- Adapt proven formats into Euphoria's micro-game structure
- AI hosts generated via HeyGen (video) + ElevenLabs (voice)
- Each show is a template that can be re-run with new content (new questions, new challenges)
- Target: produce shows at near-zero marginal cost per episode

Phase 2: Creator Tools (Post-PMF)

- Self-serve tools for creators to build and host their own shows
- Template library (pick a format, customize content, choose an AI host or use your own)
- Revenue share model for creator-hosted shows
- This turns Euphoria from a product into a **platform** — and platforms win

Content Flywheel

```
Shows produce PlayClips
       |
PlayClips drive daily engagement
       |
Daily engagement → larger live audience
       |
Larger audience → more creators want to host shows
       |
More shows → more PlayClips → more engagement → ...
```

User Journey

First-Time User Experience (FTUE)

1. Download → Quick onboarding (10 seconds max, show don't tell)
2. Drop user into a **mini Live Show simulation** — 3 games, feel the elimination tension, no real stakes
3. Show them what they just played: "That was from last night's show with 800K players. The next one starts in 2 hours."
4. Redirect to PlayClips feed to build the habit while they wait
5. Push notification when next show starts

Daily Returning User (Non-Show Time)

1. Open app → PlayClips feed (immediate engagement, no loading screen, no lobby)
2. Scroll and play clips — async competition against real players
3. Earn small coin rewards for performance
4. See countdown to next Live Show + "Join" reminder
5. Optionally: check profile, stats, cosmetics, leaderboard

Daily Returning User (Show Time)

1. Push notification: "Live Show starting in 5 minutes!"
2. Open app → Show lobby (player count climbing, host intro, energy building)
3. Show starts → 10-12 games, progressive elimination
4. If eliminated → retry (spend coins) or spectate the rest of the show
5. If survived → prize distribution, celebration, highlight reel
6. Show ends → PlayClips feed while waiting for next show

Key Product Bets

These are the beliefs underpinning this product. If any are wrong, we need to rethink.

#	Bet	Why We Believe It	What Would Disprove It
1	**Live synchronous game shows can consistently attract millions**	HQ Trivia proved the demand (12M peak). It failed on monetization and retention, not on the core concept.	If user acquisition cost is prohibitively high, or if appointment fatigue sets in faster than we expect
2	**Progressive elimination creates monetizable tension**	Loss aversion is the most powerful force in consumer spending (Royal Match, Candy Crush). Elimination + retry is the purest expression of it.	If users feel retries are "unfair" or "pay to win" and reject the mechanic
3	**PlayClips solve the "what happens between shows" problem**	TikTok proved infinite scroll of short content is habit-forming. Making it interactive (playable) should increase engagement, not decrease it.	If PlayClip engagement is low and users only open the app for shows
4	**AI-generated shows can feel premium enough**	HeyGen + ElevenLabs quality is approaching uncanny valley. For a game show host format, it's sufficient — personality matters more than photorealism.	If users find AI hosts off-putting or engagement drops vs. human-hosted shows
5	**No real-money prizes still works**	The "prize" is survival, status, and virtual currency. Mobile gaming proves people will pay for virtual progress. Game shows prove people will compete for pride alone.	If user motivation craters without cash prizes as the carrot

Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
HQ Trivia repeat — massive hype, rapid churn	High	PlayClips solve the retention gap. Monetization doesn't depend on venture-funded prize pools.
Elimination feels punishing, not fun	High	Post-elimination UX is critical: spectator mode keeps users emotionally invested (and builds future retry intent). Retry pricing must feel fair, not predatory.
AI show quality isn't good enough	Medium	Start with formats that are forgiving (trivia host doesn't need nuanced acting). Invest in host personality scripting. Human host fallback.
Matchmaking at low scale	Medium	PlayClip async matching can use wider time windows at low scale. Live Shows need critical mass — focus launches on 1-2 markets to concentrate users.
Cheating in competitive live environment	Medium	Server-side game logic validation. Anomaly detection on response times. Progressive trust scoring.
Monetization feels pay-to-win	Medium	Retries should be limited per show (e.g., max 3). Powerups should be mild advantages, not guarantees. Communicate clearly: spending gives you another chance, not a free pass.

Phased Roadmap (High-Level)

Phase 1: MVP ("Prove the Core Loop")

- 3-5 game types built and playable
- Single Live Show format (one AI host, one theme)
- Progressive elimination with retry monetization
- Basic PlayClips feed with async matchmaking
- Single currency economy (earn + spend + buy)
- Launch in one market to concentrate player density
- **Goal:** Validate that (a) Live Shows retain and monetize, and (b) PlayClips drive daily return

Phase 2: Scale ("Build the Engine")

- 8-12 game types
- Multiple show formats and themes
- Localized shows (AI dubbing, regional hosts)
- Expanded show cadence (6-8 per day)
- Recommendation engine for PlayClips
- Social features: friends, share clips, invite to shows
- Ad monetization layer (OTT + playable ads)
- Cosmetics and item shop
- **Goal:** Grow DAU to 3M+, achieve positive unit economics

Phase 3: Platform ("Open the Gates")

- Creator tools for building and hosting shows
- Revenue share model for creators
- Show discovery and recommendation engine
- Seasonal events and limited-time shows
- Advanced meta-game (progression, achievements, leagues)
- Global coverage with 24/7 show availability
- **Goal:** Platform flywheel engaged, path to $1B revenue visible

---

Open Questions (For Founders Input)

1. **Retry limits per show** — Should retries be unlimited (maximize revenue per show) or capped (e.g., max 3, to preserve competitive integrity)? My recommendation: cap at 3, because perceived fairness drives long-term retention more than short-term ARPU.

2. **Spectator mode depth** — *Decided: spectate by default after elimination.* Remaining question: can spectators see the actual game (play along without stakes) or just the host/commentary and results? My recommendation: let them see and "play" the game without stakes — this maximizes the "I knew that!" regret that drives future purchases. Engineering cost is lower too, since we're rendering the same game UI.

3. **Social features priority** — Friends, leaderboards, "invite to show," clip sharing — these are table stakes for a $1B social entertainment product. How early do we build them? My recommendation: basic friends + show invites in Phase 1, full social in Phase 2.

4. **Launch market** — Where do we launch first? India (massive mobile gaming market, game show culture), US (highest ARPU, HQ Trivia proved demand), or Southeast Asia (high engagement, lower CAC)? This shapes localization priority and show timing.

5. **Brand and personality** — What's the *tone* of Euphoria? Is it high-energy and bombastic (like a real game show)? Playful and irreverent (like Jackbox)? Sleek and premium (like Apple Arcade)? This affects everything from host personality to UI design to marketing.

6. **Show naming and identity** — Do individual shows have names and identities (like TV shows), or is it all "Euphoria" with different themes? Named shows create loyalty and anticipation ("Tune in for Brain Blitz tonight!"). My recommendation: named shows.

This document is a living artifact. It will evolve with every decision, every playtest, and every piece of user data we collect. v2 will follow once the open questions above are resolved and the first user research is in.